

Learning Guide Unit 7

Reading Assignment

As you go through the readings and watch the video, consider the following:

1. What is considered to be children's literature?
 2. What are the elements of fantasy literature?
 3. What is science fiction?
 4. What is magical realism?
 5. What common patterns are noticeable in fantasy literature across cultures?
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Reading Resources

The following are works of children's literature, fantasy literature and science fiction:

1. Getty, L., Kwon, K., Kelley, R., & Thomson, D. (2020). [World Literature I: Beginnings to 1650](https://alg.manifoldapp.org/projects/world-literature-i). In *Open ALG*. University System of Georgia, University Press of North Georgia. <https://alg.manifoldapp.org/projects/world-literature-i>

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- Read Part Two
 - Middle East
 - Selection from *The Thousand and One Nights* - "[The Story of the Husband and the Parrot](#)" (p. 410), a fantasy short story involving magic.

2. Turlington, A., Horton, M., Dodson, K., Getty, L., Kwon, K., & Ng, L. (2022). [Compact Anthology of World Literature II](https://alg.manifoldapp.org/projects/compact-anthology-of-world-literature-ii). In *Open ALG*. University System of Georgia, University Press of North Georgia <https://alg.manifoldapp.org/projects/compact-anthology-of-world-literature-ii>.

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- Read Part Five
 - Unit 1 – Romanticism
 - [The Last Man](#) (p. 549) by Mary Shelley, early science fiction depicting a post-apocalyptic world devastated by plague.
 - Unit 2 – Realism
 - [The War of the Worlds](#) (p. 1372) by H.G. Wells, a science fiction narrative about alien invasion and humanity's survival.
- Read Part Six
 - Unit 1 – Modernism
 - ["The Cabuliwallah"](#) (p. 3) by Rabindranath Tagore, a classic children's story about a friendship between a little girl and a merchant.
 - ["The Garden of Forking Paths"](#) (p. 324) by Jorge Luis Borges, a foundational text of magical realism, blending time, space, and reality.
 - Unit 3 – Contemporary Literature
 - [A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings](#) (p. 338) by Gabriel García Márquez, a classic magical realist story where an angel-like figure disrupts ordinary life.
 - [Zaabalawi](#) (p. 337) by Naguib Mahfouz, a quest narrative with mystical and spiritual elements, placing it within magical realism.
 - ["The Second Bakery Attack"](#) (p. 345) by Haruki Murakami, a short story with fantastical elements.

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3. Ray, S. (2021). *Professor Shonku and Robu* (A. Sen, Trans.) [Online]. Booksie; Booksie. Retrieved September 25, 2024, from <https://www.booksie.com/660649-professor-shonku-and-robu> (Original work published 1968).

- This is a science fiction work about a scientist who creates a fully functional artificially intelligent robot.

Background Readings

1. Tolkien, J. R. R. (n.d.). On *Fairy Stories*. <https://ieas-szeged.hu/downtherabbithole/wp-content/uploads/2020/02/Tolkien-On-Fairy-Stories.pdf>

- This article is a write-up on fairy stories by the renowned writer J.R.R. Tolkien.

2. Mallik, N. (2024). "An overview of fantasy literature, science fiction and magical realism". *University of the People*. [An Overview of Fantasy Literature, Science Fiction and Magical Realism.pdf](#)

- This article provides an overview of fantasy literature, children's literature, science fiction and magical realism, with examples.